

SIDE PLANK

Vasisthasana

Side Plank is a challenging arm balance that may get you sweating and your heart pounding. This pose is particularly beneficial for anyone looking to improve their focus and endurance. Holding Side Plank takes concentration to keep your hips from sagging.

THE BIG PICTURE

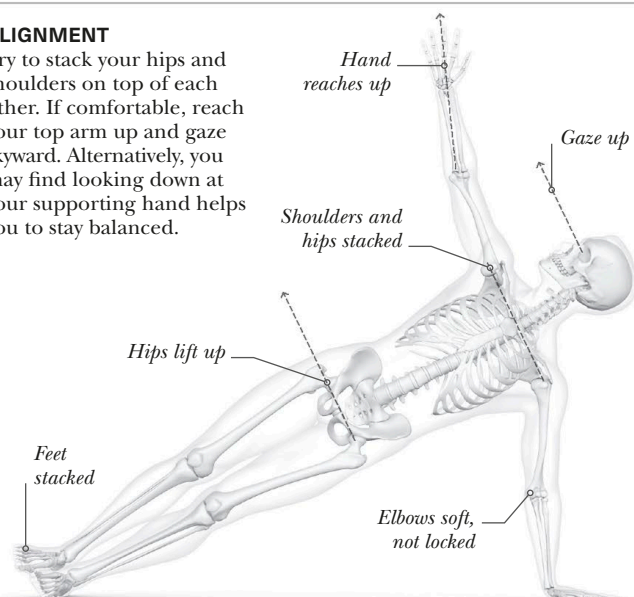
This pose strengthens your core—including your abdominals and back muscles. Your supporting arm and shoulder muscles are also engaging strongly to maintain balance. Even your leg muscles are working to support you and keep you aligned and balanced.

KEY

- Joints
- Muscles
- Engaging
- Engaging while stretching
- Stretching

ALIGNMENT

Try to stack your hips and shoulders on top of each other. If comfortable, reach your top arm up and gaze skyward. Alternatively, you may find looking down at your supporting hand helps you to stay balanced.



Top thigh

Your **hip adductors** engage on both sides to stabilize your thighs.

Lower legs

Your **ankle dorsiflexors** engage to dorsiflex your ankles and extend your toes. Your **calf muscles** are in a stretched position. Press the side of your foot into the floor to activate your **fibularis muscles** in your bottom leg, preventing your ankle from rolling downward.

